

Booking Platform

A. Executive Summary

This project proposes the development of a *web-based* local service booking platform that connects service seekers with local service providers through a competitive bidding and scheduling system. Users can post service requests such as haircuts, massages, or home services, while providers respond with price bids and availability. Once a booking is confirmed, the system automatically updates provider calendars to prevent scheduling conflicts. The platform also includes a rating and review system to promote service quality and trust. The goal of the application is to simplify local service discovery, improve booking efficiency, and create a transparent and competitive marketplace for both users and service providers.

B. Business Objectives

1. Business Need / Opportunity / Objectives

Many local service providers rely on manual booking, messaging apps, or fragmented platforms that do not offer real-time scheduling, pricing transparency, or customer feedback. Customers often struggle to find available providers, compare prices, and trust service quality.

This project addresses the opportunity to create a centralized platform that:

- Improves accessibility to local services
- Reduces booking conflicts and delays
- Encourages fair pricing through provider bidding
- Builds trust through verified reviews and ratings

Business Objectives:

- Reduce service booking time by at least **30%** compared to manual methods
- Prevent scheduling conflicts through automated calendar updates
- Increase customer satisfaction by enabling provider ratings and reviews

- Encourage competitive pricing through a bid-based request system

2. Product Description (Solution)

The proposed solution is a digital service marketplace that allows users to post service requests and receive bids from local providers. Users can compare bids, provider ratings, and availability before confirming a booking.

Solution Description:

- Users create service requests with preferred time, location, and service details
- Providers submit price bids and availability
- Users select a provider and confirm the booking
- Provider calendars automatically update to avoid conflicts
- Users can rate and review providers after service completion

Benefits:

- Faster and more transparent booking process
- Reduced scheduling errors
- Improved service quality through user feedback
- Increased visibility and opportunities for local providers

Success Criteria:

- The system successfully prevents double bookings
- Average booking confirmation time is reduced
- At least **80%** of test users can complete a booking without assistance
- Ratings and reviews are accurately stored and displayed

3. Deliverables

Deliverables Include:

- A user-facing service request and booking system
- Provider bidding and availability management module
- Calendar booking and blocking feature
- Rating and review system
- Database to store users, providers, bookings, and reviews
- Basic reporting and administrative functionality

Deliverables Exclude:

- Payment processing integration
- Third-party calendar synchronization (e.g., Google Calendar)
- Server infrastructure beyond development environment
- Real customer data

C. Project Description

1. Scope

Includes:

- User account creation and login
- Posting and managing service requests
- Provider bidding on service requests
- Booking confirmation workflow
- Automatic provider calendar updates

- Rating and review functionality

Does Not Include:

- Online payments
- Provider background checks
- Mobile push notifications
- Marketing or advertising features

2. Completion Criteria

The project will be considered complete when:

- All core features are implemented and functional
- Users can post requests and confirm bookings
- Providers can submit bids and manage availability
- Calendar conflicts are prevented
- Ratings and reviews are stored and displayed correctly
- The application passes functional testing scenarios

3. Measures of Project Success

Project success will be measured using:

- Reduction in booking conflicts to **zero** during testing
- Average booking completion time under **2 minutes**
- Successful completion of predefined user test scenarios

- Positive usability feedback from test users
- System reliability with no critical errors during demonstrations

D. Project Approval Form

I, Jin Li, have reviewed the information contained in this document and approve the project proposal.

Signature

Date